

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION – May 20, 2026

9:00a.m. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron A. Smith, Chair-Commissioner(excused); Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner and Gary L. Richardson, Commissioner, Nikole Guzman, Recorder

These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

1. **CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m.

2. **DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:**

The commissioners reserved their right to declare a potential conflict of interest.

3. **ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION(S) IN CONSIDERATION OF:**

4. **REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS:** *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*

Judy Aherns, Josephine County, congratulated those who won the primary and encouraged everyone to pick up signs. And spoke in opposition to health clinics.

Chaz Rogers, Josephine County, spoke about Pipe-fork geology and water/streams in the county.

Curtis Peirce, Josephine County, business owner manufacturer for tools to help mitigate landscaping looking to expand the business but having issues with Fire Insurance. Looking into Oregon Fair plan but can't qualify.

5. **BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:**

The Board addressed public comments

6. **APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:**

a. Minutes (draft minutes are available for viewing in the board's office)

Executive Session – May 11, 2026

Executive Session – May 11, 2026

Admin Workshop – May 12, 2026

Weekly Business Session – May 13, 2026

Legal Update Meeting – May 14, 2026

Admin Workshop – May 14, 2026

AMPAC Advisory Board Minutes – April 16, 2026

Fair board Minutes – March 17, 2026

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve the Consent Calendar, seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – absent. Motion carried 2-0.

7. **OTHER: (ORS 192.640(1))** *“ . . . notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.”*

8. **ANNOUNCEMENTS: MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS:**

Commissioner Richardson addressed public comments circulating online regarding recent facility tours conducted jointly by Commissioners Richardson and Commissioner Martin. Commissioner Richardson referenced ORS 192.610(6)(b) and Oregon Administrative Rule 199-050-0015 regarding on-site inspections and public meeting requirements, stating that the facility visits consisted solely of observational inspections of County facilities and properties and did not involve deliberations or decision-making. Richardson stated that the joint inspections were conducted to improve efficiency and reduce staff time associated with conducting separate tours.

Commissioner Richardson additionally discussed upcoming Budget Committee meetings and requested that County departments prepare simplified revenue breakdowns identifying local, state, and federal funding sources for budget presentations. Richardson encouraged departments to identify one-time or potentially at-risk grant funding and discuss possible future impacts associated with changes in federal and state funding structures.

Commissioner Richardson also discussed emergency preparedness and wildfire readiness resources available to the public, including evacuation alert systems and emergency “go bag” preparation materials. Demonstrations were provided regarding public access to emergency alert signup information through the County website, and Richardson encouraged residents to familiarize themselves with evacuation zone information and emergency preparedness planning.

Commissioner Martin reminded the public of upcoming Memorial Day community events and expressed appreciation for the work performed by the Active Club in organizing local festivities. Martin encouraged residents to celebrate responsibly, drive safely, and remember the significance of Memorial Day in honoring military personnel who lost their lives in service to the country.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:23 a.m.



Nikole Guzman, Recorder